

Higher MP Count

Pros

1. The more the pixels, the sharper the picture.
2. A larger pixel size gives you the flexibility to crop the picture and then print or view it at its original (uncropped) size.
3. It is possible to magnify the picture to a bigger size with a bigger MP count (before the pixels become visible to the naked eye). The upper limit of magnification also depends on the number of pixels in the picture. Generally, the greater the number of pixels, the larger the size of the photo that can be viewed or printed.

Cons

1. A higher-megapixel camera is generally costlier than other models with lower MP count.
2. More megapixels correspond to bigger file sizes of the photos. This means that you will require lots of space on the disk of your computer (if that's where you will store all your photos). However, if you'll only print photos without storing them, the large megapixel size doesn't matter.
3. There is no point paying extra for unnecessary picture quality. It depends on what you are going to do with your photos. So choose accordingly.

to lock into a shot once you press the shutter half-way down.

Size, weight and design

Digital SLRs are usually bulky. Needless to say, if you like to capture 'live' moments on the move, a light-weight point-and-shoot camera will be a better option. However, small cameras work best in auto mode only as they do not give you the flexibility of manual control of shutter speed and other features. Also, their size can make them difficult to manoeuvre, as the buttons are few and small. They

serve the purpose for a beginner, but lag behind for advanced and creative photography.

Zoom lens and image stabilisation

With optical zoom feature, you can zoom in on the subject from a distance and capture the smallest of details. Zoom in on kids on a soccer field or a jet skier on the lake, to see their expressions as they enjoy their sport.

In simple terms, optical zoom means actual zoom done by the lenses (lenses physically extend to magnify your sub-

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ject). Digital zoom, on the other hand, simply increases the size of the picture display without increasing any detail.

A 3x optical zoom means you can get three times closer picture of the subject than seen with your eyes. There are options of 'W' and 'T' which help you in manually controlling the optical zoom. 'W' stands for 'wide-angle' (reduce) and 'T' for 'telephoto' (magnify).

Digital zoom magnifies the image by cropping it. This is done by a process called interpolation. Digital zoom interpolates or makes up for the cropped area and adds pixels to the image in order to make it look bigger. However, this sacrifices the image quality to a certain extent. In general, a higher optical zoom is preferred to a larger digital zoom for better image quality.

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Storage

Cameras have inbuilt flash memory but their storage space is limited. So you have to buy external memory cards like CompactFlash, Secure Digital (SD) or Secure Digital High Capacity (SDHC). The storage capacity depends on the memory space of the card. For instance, a 32MB CompactFlash card can store more images than an 8MB card.

Generally, most cameras come with a 1GB SD or SDHC card depending on the model. Before buying a memory card, check its compatibility with the memory card slot of the camera. SDHC

SONY

DSC-TX9

Features

- Dimensions: 97.8x59.5x17.5 mm³
- Weight: Approx. 133 gm (body), approx. 149 gm with accessories
- Resolution: Approx. 12.2 megapixels
- Optical zoom: 4x
- LCD screen: 8.9cm, 921,000-pixel, Xtra Fine TruBlack, touch screen
- HD video recording: Yes, full HD video shooting
- Others: 3D sweep panorama, sweep multi-angle, Exmor R CMOS sensor, superior auto mode and 25mm wide-angle Carl Zeiss Vario-Tessar lens



Price: ₹ 14,990